

KNOW YOUR

CUSTOMER

Mastercard

Context before conversation.

WHY THIS MATTERS

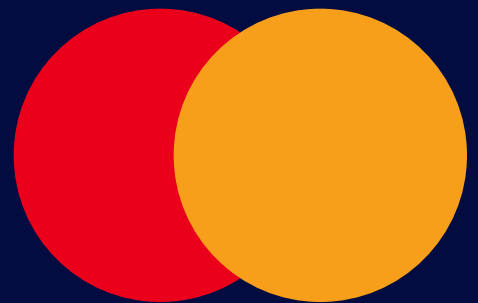
You probably recognize the Mastercard brand.

But recognition is not understanding. Use this guide to build context - then let Discovery teach you what matters to the customer.

GLOBAL TECHNOLOGY

PAYMENTS + SERVICES

SECURITY + INNOVATION



Your job is not to memorize Mastercard. Your job is to arrive informed enough to ask better questions.

Mastercard in one minute

Start with the big picture - not just the card in your wallet.

GLOBAL TECHNOLOGY COMPANY

Mastercard describes itself as a global technology company in the payments industry.

210+ COUNTRIES & TERRITORIES

Its technology and services connect individuals and organizations across more than 210 countries and territories.

DIGITAL ECONOMY

Its stated focus is helping make transactions safe, simple, smart and accessible.

MORE THAN PAYMENTS

Its work also spans areas such as cybersecurity and fraud prevention, insights and intelligence, open finance, money movement, and commercial payments.

NETWORK + PARTNERSHIPS

Mastercard connects consumers, businesses, financial institutions, governments and other partners across a global ecosystem.

TRUST AT SCALE

Security, privacy, reliability and resilience are central considerations in the payments network it operates.

Think ecosystem, not just product

A payment experience can involve many participants, systems, decisions, and constraints.

PEOPLE

Consumers and end users

Ask how this part of the ecosystem shapes the customer experience.

BUSINESSES

Merchants and enterprises

Ask how this part of the ecosystem shapes the customer experience.

FINANCIAL INSTITUTIONS

Banks and other financial partners

Ask how this part of the ecosystem shapes the customer experience.

GOVERNMENTS

Public-sector organizations

Ask how this part of the ecosystem shapes the customer experience.

TECHNOLOGY

Networks, platforms and digital experiences

Ask how this part of the ecosystem shapes the customer experience.

TRUST

Security, privacy, fraud prevention and resilience

Ask how this part of the ecosystem shapes the customer experience.

DISCOVERY MINDSET

The stakeholder you meet may represent only one part of a much larger system. Understand their reality before defining the problem.

What should you be curious about?

Use company context to improve your questions - never to pre-decide the answer.

EXPERIENCE

Where does the current experience create friction for people or teams?

PROCESS

How does work move today? Where are the handoffs, delays, or manual steps?

DATA

What information is needed? Where does it come from? Who can access it?

TRUST

What security, privacy, fraud, compliance, or reliability considerations matter?

SCALE

Who is affected, how often, and what changes when the process operates at scale?

OUTCOME

What does the customer actually want to improve - and how would they recognize success?

What not to assume

Knowing the company gives you context. Discovery gives you evidence.

ASSUMPTION

“Mastercard is just a credit card company.”

RESET

Think broader: technology, payments, services, data, security, partnerships and digital experiences.

ASSUMPTION

“The challenge must be about payments.”

RESET

Do not guess the challenge. Let the customer conversation define the problem.

ASSUMPTION

“Because this is a tech event, the answer must be AI.”

RESET

Technology follows the need. AI may or may not be appropriate.

ASSUMPTION

“We already understand the user.”

RESET

You do not. Ask who experiences the problem, what happens today, and why it matters.

ASSUMPTION

“A cool demo equals customer value.”

RESET

A strong solution connects what you build to a validated need and meaningful outcome.

BEFORE DISCOVERY

Know enough to ask better questions.



I can explain Mastercard beyond 'a card company.'



I understand that Mastercard operates within a broad global ecosystem.



I know security, privacy, reliability and customer experience may matter - but I will not assume how.



I will not guess the challenge before hearing from the customer.



I will use company context to ask sharper follow-ups, not to pitch a prebuilt idea.

THE RULE

Context informs Discovery.
It does not replace it.

NEXT → Open your Question Guide and prepare to listen.